

Medi-Cal FFS FAQ Cheat Sheet: Countering Provider Excuses

Patient: Brandy Michelle Bianchini **Authority:** DHCS Medi-Cal Transportation FAQ & CCR Title 22

EXCUSE 1: “We don’t sign Physician Certification Statements (PCS).”

THE LAW: A completed and signed PCS (Form MC 396) is **MANDATORY** for a member to access Non-Emergency Medical Transportation (NEMT).

- **Source:** DHCS FAQ #5: *“A completed PCS form is required for members to access NEMT.”*
- **Mandate:** Refusal to sign prevents access to medically necessary covered services.

EXCUSE 2: “We only authorize local care. Santa Monica is too far.”

THE LAW: Medi-Cal covers transportation to the **nearest available provider** capable of providing the service.

- **Source:** DHCS FAQ #12: *“Medi-Cal covers transportation to the nearest available provider... if the service is not available in your local community.”*
- **Fact:** No provider within 50 miles of Shingle Springs possesses the required genomic protocol for STX16/PMS2 variants. Santa Monica is the nearest *capable* provider.

EXCUSE 3: “We don’t handle lodging or meal reimbursement.”

THE LAW: For FFS members, the PCP must sign the **Pre-Authorization Request for Lodging & Meals** if the appointment requires overnight travel.

- **Source:** DHCS FFS NMT/NEMT Pre-Authorization Form Instructions: *“Pre-authorization is required for all Medi-Cal approved appointments... the member will need to complete and submit a completed form.”* (Requires Physician verification).

EXCUSE 4: “You can just take a bus or a regular car.”

THE LAW: NEMT (Specialized Transit) is authorized when the member’s medical condition **contraindicates** the use of public or private transportation.

- **Source:** CCR Title 22, Section 51323: *“NEMT is covered when the beneficiary’s medical and physical condition is such that transport by ordinary means... is medically contraindicated.”*

- **Fact:** Autonomic collapse risk (G-protein signaling failure) makes ordinary transit a life-safety risk.

EXCUSE 5: “We can just use DocuSign.”

THE LAW: DHCS **strictly prohibits** digital signatures or copies for FFS reimbursement.

- **Source:** DHCS FFS Pre-Authorization Instructions: *“The form must have an ORIGINAL SIGNATURE (copies will not be accepted, nor will DocuSign).”*
- **Mandate:** Provide an original signature in blue or black ink and a physical provider stamp.